ThoughtSpot — Marketing Site, Onboarding, Adoption & Design Language

Observed 30–31 Aug 2026 across thoughtspot.com, docs.thoughtspot.com and developers.thoughtspot.com. All quotes are verbatim. In-product screens are reconstructed from documentation, not from a live trial account; gaps are flagged [UNVERIFIED].

Full site map as observed

Global header — two persistent CTAs, right-aligned: "Get demo" and "Free trial". Language switcher: English / Deutsch / ■■■ / French.

Nav item	Children
Agents	AgentSpot; Spotter: AI Analyst; SpotterModel; SpotterViz; SpotterCode
Product	BI Agents; Semantic Layer; AI-Augmented Dashboards; Automated Insights; Actionable Insights; Any Data Anywhere; Enterprise Analytics; Embedded Analytics; Analyst Studio
Solutions	By role: Business Leader, Data Leader, Data Analyst, Product Leader, Developer, Sales Operations · By industry: Financial Services, Retail & CPG, Healthcare & Life Sciences, Technology & Software, Supply Chain, Media & Telecom · By size: Startup, Enterprise
Customers	(single page, filterable)
Pricing	(single page)
Resources	Data Trends Blog; Analyst Reports; Case Studies; Ebooks; Glossary; Product Videos; Webinars; Documentation; Training
Company	Team; Careers; Trust Center; Partners; Contact Us; Support Center; Press Releases; Blog; In the News

URLs confirmed reachable: / · /agentspot · /product/agents (+ /spotter, /spotterviz) · /product/analytics (+ /spotiq) · /product/visualize · /product/automated-analytics · /business-leader · /data-leader · /analyst · /product-leader · /solutions/teams · /customers · /pricing · /trial · /trust · /brand · /resources · /training · /spotter-embed · /dataspot · docs.thoughtspot.com/cloud/26.8.0.cl/index.html · developers.thoughtspot.com/getstarted · training.thoughtspot.com · community.thoughtspot.com

Notable: persona pages sit at the root (/business-leader, /analyst, /data-leader) rather than under /solutions/, which the nav implies. The footer adds a Comparisons column — Sigma, Domo, Omni, Power BI, Tableau — a bottom-funnel bake-off shelf kept out of the main nav.

Docs IA (docs.thoughtspot.com): product-line tabs across the top — Cloud, Software, Mobile, AgentSpot, Embedded. Landing page leads with four agent cards, then eight icon tiles: "What's new" · "Administration" · "Deploying ThoughtSpot" · "Getting started for end users" · "Embedded" · "Homepage and navigation" · "Liveboards" · "Spotter semantics". Note that the end user has a named front door of their own, peer to Administration.

Pricing page (/pricing) — published, self-serve, two product families. ThoughtSpot Analytics: Essentials from $25/user/mo (5–50 users, 25M rows) — "For small teams to find and share insights with AI analytics"; Pro from $50/user/mo (to 1,000 users, 250M rows, "Unlimited LLM tokens included", Spotter at 25 queries/user/mo), also offered usage-based from $0.10/credit; Enterprise custom. ThoughtSpot Embedded: Developer free for one year (10 users), Enterprise flexible. Every Analytics tier's CTA is "Try for free" — the trial, not the demo, is the default next step at every price point.

Positioning and language

The site is mid-pivot from "search analytics" to "agentic analytics." The homepage runs two stacked heroes: a launch bar for "Introducing AgentSpot" — "Multiplayer AI so anyone can build, share, and collaborate with agents connected to company data, context and tools" — above the evergreen hero, "Data to Decisions, Powered by Agents Analytics and BI" / "Agentic Analytics Platform that empowers every decision with live, explainable AI insights – right inside your tools and workflows."

The vocabulary, as a set of oppositions. Almost every claim is built as trusted thing vs. stale thing:

- "Don't let your data die in dashboards", "static, stale dashboards" (/business-leader)
- "Answers You Can Trust. Decisions You Can Move On." (/product/agents/spotter)
- "Accuracy Starts Before Analysis" — "Business logic, joins, calendars, calculations, and security are governed before teams ask the first question." (homepage)
- "Governed Answers, Fast" — "trusted answers grounded in verified business definitions."
- "Enterprise-grade guardrails with consumer-grade UX" (/data-leader)

"Self-service" is used as a reclaimed term, not a neutral one. The recurring heading is "Self-service analytics the way it was meant to be" — an admission that the category promised this and failed. On /product/analytics: "ThoughtSpot Analytics empowers everyone—from the C-suite to frontline teams—to get immediate answers to their business questions and make fact-driven decisions."

Jargon substitutions worth stealing. They rarely say "dashboard" (→ Liveboard), "query" (→ ask / just ask), "report" (→ Answer, capital A), "model retraining" (→ coaching), "NL2SQL" (→ "translates questions into search tokens grounded in your governed semantic layer"). The Spotter hero is "An Analyst At Your Fingertips" — a person metaphor, not a tool metaphor, repeated as "Give everyone an analyst at their fingertips." The most human line on the site is /business-leader's "It's time you and your data had a chat."

Proof is numeric and placed early. On /product/agents/spotter: "99.6% Reduction in time-to-insight", "62% Customer adoption in production in <1 year", "2x Leader in Gartner Magic Quadrant for Data & Analytics."

Personas and how each is served

Six role pages, each with its own hero promise and its own villain:

Persona	Headline	Sub	Villain named
Business Leader	"The search is over"	"Find trusted insights when and where you work"	"waiting for reports or dashboards from your data team"; "traditional BI roadblocks"
Data Analyst	"Less Dashboard Busywork. More Business Impact."	"Ditch the backlog of one-off requests…"	the ad-hoc request queue
Data Leader	"Embrace the new AI"	"Turn data into your team's shared language"	"From chaos to confidence, at enterprise scale"
Product Leader / Developer	(embedded analytics framing)	—	build-vs-buy cost

The analyst page is the tell: rather than positioning self-service as replacing analysts, it sells analysts their own liberation — "There was a very heavy dependency on the analyst, but they don't want to work on a lot of small, ad hoc questions. They're here to solve bigger, more strategic questions." And Spotter's second benefit pillar is explicitly about the analyst's workload: "By letting business teams answer more questions on their own, Spotter reduces ad hoc requests to data teams, and frees them to focus on what matters most—governance, models, and high-value analysis." The gatekeeper is made a beneficiary.

Customer quotes dramatise the same shift: "My team is out of the dashboarding business."

(HP) · "I just typed into the search bar and a visualization appeared. She said, 'Oh my gosh—this is great!'" (Wellthy) · "90% of the company still depends on the 10% that is the data team. That is not data democratization." (Lyft).

Onboarding a non-technical user: the pattern

Reconstructed from /trial, docs.thoughtspot.com/cloud/latest/getting-started-free-trial, and .../user-onboarding-experience.

0 — The offer. /trial: a 14-day free trial, "No credit card required", framed in consumer terms — "Experience search & AI-driven analytics as easy as your favorite app." Logos (Capital One, Nasdaq, Unilever, LegalZoom) plus SOC / GDPR / HIPAA / ISO / STAR badges
sit on the signup page: risk-reduction at the moment of hesitation. CTA:
"Start your 14-day free trial."

1 — Account activation. Create a Community account → welcome email → activation link → set password (8+ chars, upper, lower, number, special). Community membership is bundled into signup, so the user joins the peer network before they see the product.

2 — First sign-in: a four-step welcome flow, not a feature tour.
- "Step 1: Get Started" — an overview of the onboarding process plus a short video. Buttons: Continue, or "Exit to homepage" top-right. Skippable from screen one.
- "Step 2: Recommended data source" — introduces one data source, pre-selected by the administrator. The new user is not asked to choose a source; the choice was made for them.
- "Step 3: Select a Liveboard" — pick one starter Liveboard to explore.
- "Step 4: View your insights" — look at that Liveboard, and a Follow button offers to "receive periodic emails about this Liveboard."

The flow's whole job is to end with the user owning one board they care about and subscribed to it. It is re-runnable: Profile → Experience → "Revisit onboarding experience."

3 — Data without data. The trial ships pre-loaded: "Spotter comes pre-populated with sample data, so you can immediately try digging into data analysis." A named starter object appears in the developer walkthrough — the "Sales West - Overview" Liveboard. Only after the user has felt a result does the product invite "Try Spotter on your own data", with three graded on-ramps: CSV upload, Google Sheets, or a cloud data warehouse.

4 — The nine-step trial checklist in docs: search with Spotter on sample data → connect your own data → model data for searches → create a Model → learn search essentials → invite up to 5 teammates → share a Liveboard. Note where "invite teammates" and "share" fall: at the end, as the pay-off, not as setup friction at the start.

5 — Landing in the product. Home modules, verbatim: a search bar with a Sources dropdown and Search data button; a KPI band headed "Track important KPIs" whose empty state reads "Add KPIs to your watchlist", each card offering "Create alert"; "Recently viewed"; and a right rail, "Trending Liveboards and Answers" — top 5 with view counts. Nav: Home · Search · Answers · Liveboards · SpotIQ · Monitor · Data · Admin, with Admin and SpotIQ shown only to users holding the privilege — the nav itself is permission-shaped.

Adoption mechanics

- Social proof inside the product. "Trending Liveboards and Answers" with view counts, and "Popular" KPIs, let a newcomer follow the herd rather than face a blank canvas.
- Follow / Watchlist / Monitor convert a one-off look into a recurring email. Adoption is

designed as subscription, not as return visits.
- Coaching, as a first-class loop. An Add Coaching flow: submit a question, correct the answer, click Done to save it as a reference question; Spotter then proposes business terms a human accepts, edits or rejects — e.g. "we can change the business term to 'revenue' instead of 'the revenue' and modify the mapped search tokens." Docs advise validating with early adopters before wide rollout. Feedback becomes a governance artefact, not a thumbs-up into a void.
- Explainability on demand: users can "ask questions about how calculated fields such as formulas are generated", and Spotter "suggest[s] questions you can ask to improve your understanding of the data analysis."
- ThoughtSpot University — instructor-led, eLearning with role-based learning paths (Business Leaders, Data Leaders, Data Analysts, Product Leaders, Developers, Sales Ops), badges on path completion, and tiered certification. Practice happens "in a live ThoughtSpot environment."
- Resources hub filterable on four axes at once — role, format ("ebook", "Webinar", "Case study", "Hands-on lab"…), topic ("Data Literacy", "Self Service Analytics"…), industry.
- Community account bundled at signup, plus a public Glossary doing category education for non-technical readers. [UNVERIFIED: glossary URL 404'd on /resources/glossary; it is linked from the footer as "Glossary".]

Visual and verbal design language

From the published brand page, thoughtspot.com/brand:

Palette — exact values.
- Primary: Dark Spot #08062B · Dark Tint #122246 · Navy Spot #1B3E61 · Navy Tint #045D7F · Blue Spot #346DC9 · Blue Tint #275595 · Cyan Spot #04D1FF · Cyan Tint #9FE9FF · White Spot #FFFFFF · White Tint #EEF7FF
- Secondary: Purple Spot #3D2894 · Blurple Spot #714BFB
- Tertiary (accent/data): #8AAFFF · #32D9DF · #C493FF · #FF92A8 · #FFC052 · #6DD267

The system is a near-black navy ground (#08062B) with one electric cyan (#04D1FF) doing all the pointing. Everything between is a ladder of blues. The six tertiaries are a ready-made categorical chart palette, tuned for the dark ground. Note the naming convention: every colour is a "Spot" with a matching "Tint" — the brand word is welded into the palette.

Typography. Geist Mono is the named brand typeface — "legible, modern, and confident" — in Medium and Regular only, used for hierarchy through weight rather than through many sizes. A monospace as a display face is a deliberate signal: technical credibility, machine-adjacent, contemporary. [UNVERIFIED: the brand page names no separate body/UI typeface; the running body face on the marketing site is not documented publicly.]

Brand page sections: Logo · Partner Branding · Typography · Color Palette · Winning With Insights · Our brand in action · Distinctive by Design. Voice guidance is a single sentence: ensure each brand interaction is "consistent, positive, sophisticated, and easy to understand." Partner lock-ups must be "equally weighted and monochromatic."

Composition. Abstract geometric marks and shapes rather than illustration or stock photography; product screenshots used as evidence beneath claims; heavy use of two- and three-up card grids ("Faster Decisions / Scale Data Impact / Ship Faster"); a repeating section rhythm of short imperative heading → one-sentence proof → screenshot or logo band. Headings are title-cased and short — 3 to 6 words, verb-forward. CTA labels are frequently ALL CAPS ("REQUEST A DEMO", "TRY SPOTTER NOW", "SEE IT IN ACTION", "SAY HELLO"). [UNVERIFIED: gradient and motion specifics — the brand page documents neither, and CSS was not retrievable.]

Trust signals for a sceptical buyer

- Trust Center (/trust) opens on a values sentence, not a certificate wall: "Nothing is more important than the trust of customers, our team, our ecosystem, our shareholders and our community." Three sections: Enterprise-Grade AI · Security · Privacy & Compliance, each with "Learn more". Certifications: SOC 1/2/3, ISO 27001, CSA STAR, HIPAA, GDPR, EU-US DPF, Swiss-US DPF, UK Extension, CCPA. A gated Security Portal exists for enterprise buyers.
- The accuracy argument is architectural, not statistical. They pre-empt the hallucination objection with a named section — "How does Spotter guarantee no hallucinations?" — and answer with mechanism: "Instead of direct text-to-SQL, Spotter translates questions into search tokens grounded in your governed semantic layer—producing fully traceable, auditable queries", plus "Foundational models and text-to-SQL solutions just don't cut it."
- AgentSpot's governance copy is the closest analogue to Spiff's invariants: "Every request, tool call and model interaction gets logged — full auditability, no black boxes" · "Fine-grained control over what every person can see and do" · "Each user's sessions, files, memory, and work is completely secure and private" · and the sharing model, "Anyone can build and share agents across the org. One person's solution becomes everyone's superpower."
- Analyst validation as a repeated band: 2026 Gartner Leader, Nucleus Leader, G2 Leader — and compliance badges appear on the signup page, not only on the trust page.

Design lessons for Spiff

1. Two heroes, one page. A launch ribbon for what's new above a stable evergreen promise — so Spiff's core pitch never has to be rewritten to announce something.
2. Name the villain in the sub-head. Every persona page names a specific indignity ("waiting for reports from your data team"). Spiff's — waiting on the GST reporting queue — belongs in the first two lines, in the user's own words.
3. Sell the gatekeeper their own liberation. The analyst page is the smartest move on the site. Spiff's reporting team must read the pitch and see less queue, not less job.
4. Give the AI a human role, not a product name. "An Analyst At Your Fingertips" sets honest expectations about fallibility and about asking follow-ups.
5. Replace jargon with owned nouns. Liveboard, Answer, Model, coaching. Fix Spiff's 4–5 nouns early and use them everywhere — nav, empty states, docs, deck.
6. Put the accuracy mechanism in the copy. "Grounded in your governed semantic layer → traceable, auditable queries" beats any accuracy percentage. Show the trace; don't assert the trust.
7. Pre-empt the objection with a heading. Title a section with the sceptic's question: "How do I know this number is right?" · "Who can see this?"
8. Onboard to one board, not to a tour. Four steps ending in one Liveboard the user follows. Spiff's first run should end with one report the user owns and subscribes to.
9. Ship data before asking for data. Sample data pre-loaded; "connect your own" arrives at step 4, after the first win. The mockup needs a plausible sample dataset from screen one.
10. Make onboarding re-runnable and exit-able from screen one. "Exit to homepage" plus Profile → "Revisit onboarding experience." Skippability is what makes a tour tolerable.
11. Beat the blank canvas with other people's work. "Trending Liveboards and Answers" with view counts. Spiff's home can show what colleagues run — while still re-running each answer per viewer, scoped to that person.
12. Design adoption as subscription. Follow / Watchlist / alerts turn one visit into a habit — and this is where Spiff's per-owner execution invariant earns its keep: the follow re-runs as the follower.
13. Make correction a governed artefact. "Add Coaching" → reference question → human-reviewed business term. Spiff's feedback loop should yield reviewable definitions, not

opaque fine-tuning.
14. Permission-shape the navigation. SpotIQ and Admin appear only with the privilege. Hide, don't grey out — the UI is the permission model made visible.
15. A one-accent palette on a deep ground. Near-black navy plus a single electric accent, with a six-colour tertiary set reserved for data. Spiff's UBT navy/blue can be structured identically: one ground, one pointer, one chart ramp — and, like ThoughtSpot, put the compliance badges at the moment of hesitation (signup, share) rather than on a trust page.